

# Foreigners in China: A Practical Guide to Registering on Chinese Social Media Platforms

What you can do, what you can't, and where to start

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**Disclaimer:** This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Platform policies change frequently. Always check each platform's official announcements for the most current rules.

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## Quick Reference Table

| Platform          | Can Foreigners Register? | Official Link                                          | Verification Method                                 |
|-------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Xiaohongshu (RED) | ✔ Yes                    | App: "Rednote" (international) or "Xiaohongshu"        | Foreign passport                                    |
| Bilibili (B 站)    | ✔ Yes                    | <a href="http://www.bilibili.com">www.bilibili.com</a> | Passport / Residence Permit / Travel Document       |
| Weibo             | ✔ Yes                    | <a href="http://www.weibo.com">www.weibo.com</a>       | Phone number (some international numbers supported) |

| Platform                        | Can Foreigners Register?      | Official Link                                                                                                | Verification Method                         |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kwai</b>                     | ✓ <b>Yes</b>                  | <a href="http://www.kwai.com">www.kwai.com</a>                                                               | International phone number / Google account |
| <b>WeChat Official Account</b>  | <b>Company only</b>           | <a href="http://mp.weixin.qq.com">mp.weixin.qq.com</a>                                                       | Foreign company registration documents      |
| <b>Douyin</b>                   | ✗ <b>No</b>                   | <a href="http://www.douyin.com">www.douyin.com</a>                                                           | Requires Chinese national ID                |
| <b>Toutiao</b>                  | <b>Uncertain</b>              | <a href="http://www.toutiao.com">www.toutiao.com</a> or <a href="http://m.p.toutiao.com">m.p.toutiao.com</a> | Must test yourself                          |
| <b>Baidu Baijiahao</b>          | <b>Requires Baidu account</b> | <a href="http://baijiahao.baidu.com">baijiahao.baidu.com</a>                                                 | Must link to a verified phone number        |
| <b>Tencent Content Platform</b> | ✗ <b>No</b>                   | <a href="http://kf.om.qq.com">kf.om.qq.com</a>                                                               | Does not support foreign IDs                |

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## Platform-by-Platform Guide

### ✓ **Xiaohongshu (RED) — Most Foreigner-Friendly**

#### **Official Link:**

International users: Search "**Rednote**" in your app store

Or download the standard "Xiaohongshu" app and select the international version during registration

### **Registration Steps:**

Download the app and open it. Select **phone login**.

**Do NOT select +86** (China country code). Choose your home country's code instead.

Enter your phone number and wait for the verification code.

Once verified, go to **Settings** → **Account & Security** → **Real-Name Verification**.

Under ID type, select "**Foreign Passport**".

Enter your nationality, full name, and passport number exactly as shown on your passport.

Upload a photo of your passport and complete the verification.

**Important Restriction:** If you verify your personal account with a foreign passport, **live streaming features may be limited or unavailable**.

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### **✓ Bilibili — Supports Passport Verification**

**Official Link:** [www.bilibili.com](https://www.bilibili.com)

### **Registration Options:**

Register directly on the website using the overseas registration option

Or register through a third-party platform

### **Real-Name Verification:**

Chinese users: Link a Chinese phone number

**Foreign users: Upload a valid ID document — passport, residence permit, or travel document**

**Note:** Unverified accounts may not be able to access certain copyrighted content. Some content from Hong Kong and Taiwan may require additional verification.

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## **✓ Weibo — Some International Phone Numbers Supported**

**Official Link:** [www.weibo.com](http://www.weibo.com)

### **Registration Options:**

**Phone number registration:** Works with Chinese numbers and **some international numbers.**

**Third-party login:** WeChat, QQ, or Apple ID.

Registering a Sina email account automatically creates a Weibo account.